Approval Flow

Vendor Bills & Purchase Orders — Multi-Level Approval Workflow

Steering Committee — Executive Summary

March 2026

How the Approval Workflow Works

Sequential multi-level approval with amount-based thresholds and rejection loops

The Flow

```
VENDOR BILL / PO CREATED
        |
        ▼
  System matches amount to approval rules
    (vendor BU + amount threshold)
        |
        ▼
  APPROVER 1 receives notification
        |
      ┌─┴─┐
   Approve    Reject
   |              |
   ▼              ▼
  APPROVER 2    Back to draft
   (if required)    (user fixes & resubmits)
   |
   ▼
  FULLY APPROVED ──> can be posted / confirmed
```

Key Design Principles

Sequential, not parallel

Approvers are ordered (sequence 10, 20, 30...). Each must approve before the next is notified. No skipping.

Amount-based thresholds

Different rules trigger depending on invoice/PO total. Small amounts may need only 1 approver; large amounts need 2-3 levels.

Vendor Business Units

Vendors are classified into BUs (e.g. Logistics, Raw Materials, Services). Each BU has its own approval chain and thresholds.

Rejection = back to start

Any rejection resets the document to draft. The submitter fixes the issue and re-submits, restarting the full approval chain.

Scope & Configuration

Vendor Bills and Purchase Orders — same engine, separate rules

Documents Covered

Document	Trigger	Blocks
Vendor Bill (account.move)	When user clicks "Request Approval"	Cannot post until fully approved
Purchase Order (purchase.order)	When user clicks "Request Approval"	Cannot confirm until fully approved

Vendor BU Examples

Vendor BU	Examples	Typical Chain
Raw Materials	Wood suppliers, chemicals	Purchasing → CFO
Logistics	Freight forwarders, customs	Logistics Mgr → CFO
Services	Consulting, IT, legal	BU Head → CFO → CEO
Subcontracting	RDK machining	Production Mgr → CFO

The kebony.approval Model

One record per document needing approval

Tracks the full approval lifecycle:

- **State:** pending / approved / rejected
- **Current approver:** who's next in the sequence
- **Approval log:** who approved/rejected, when, with comments
- **Amount:** total amount that triggered the rule
- **Rule matched:** which BU + threshold applied

Notifications & Audit

- Email notification sent to each approver when it's their turn
- Chatter message on the document for every approve/reject action
- Full audit trail — who, when, what, comments
- Dashboard: "My Approvals" shows pending items per user

Security: Only designated approvers can approve. The "Approve" button is invisible to non-approvers. Users cannot approve their own requests.

Why This Matters

From informal email approval to auditable, enforced workflow

Today (without)

- Approval by email or verbal OK
- No audit trail
- Anyone can post a vendor bill
- POs confirmed without budget check
- No visibility on pending approvals
- Risk of unauthorized spend

Tomorrow (with)

- Approval enforced in the system
- Full audit trail with timestamps
- Posting blocked until approved
- Amount-based escalation
- "My Approvals" dashboard
- Rejection loop with comments

Key Benefits

- **Compliance:** Segregation of duties
- **Control:** No spend without approval
- **Visibility:** Real-time approval status
- **Speed:** No more chasing emails
- **Audit:** Instant trail for external auditors
- **Scalable:** Add BUs, thresholds, approvers as org grows

Implementation status: Custom Odoo module (`kebony_bol_report`) — ready for deployment. Requires configuration of Vendor BUs, approval rules, and approver assignments per company. No third-party module dependency.